

CENTRAL MICHIGAN UNIVERSITY
COURSE SYLLABUS

I. IDENTIFYING INFORMATION

Course: PSY 285
Course Title: Research Methods
EPN: 22348309
Term: Spring II
Location: Online
Course Dates: 3/5, 4/27/2018
Course Days and Times: N/A

Prerequisites: Prerequisite: PSY 100; PSY 211, or BIO 500, or HSC 544 pr HSC 544 with a grade of C or better.

Blackboard:

Blackboard is a web-based learning management system licensed by CMU. Within Blackboard, a course website, also known as a shell, is automatically created for every CMU course. Face-to-face courses may or may not incorporate Blackboard, whereas Blackboard course shells are always used for online courses and will be available to you prior to the course start date. Seeing the course shell listed in Blackboard with unavailable adjacent to its title is an indication that your instructor has not made it available and is in no way indicative of registration status. To access Blackboard, open a web browser and enter <https://blackboard.cmich.edu/webapps/login/>. After the site loads, enter your CMU Global ID and password in the respective spaces provided. Click the "login" button to enter Blackboard and then the link to the appropriate course to enter the course's Blackboard shell. If you need assistance, contact the IT Helpdesk at 989-774-3662 / 800-950-1144 x. 3662. Self-guided student tutorial resources are also available at <https://blackboard.cmich.edu/webapps/login/>.

Instructor: Joshua Keene
Primary Phone Number: 810-287-5699
Secondary Phone Number: N/A
E-Mail Address: keene2j@cmich.edu
Availability: Monday through Friday 9:00 A.M. to 5:00 P.M.

Academic Biography:

I have a bachelors degree in psychology from Michigan State University. I am currently a Ph.D. student in the Experimental Psychology program at Central Michigan University. I am a research assistant in the Neuroinflammation, Aging, and Alzheimers Lab at Central Michigan University. My primary research interest is determining the impact inflammatory stress has on the pathogenesis of Alzheimer's Disease.

II. TEXTBOOKS AND INSTRUCTIONAL MATERIALS

Order books from MBS at <http://bookstore.mbsdirect.net/cmuh.htm>

Textbooks and Course Materials:

Title: Methods in Behavioral Research (E-book Available)
Author: Cozby
Edition: 12th
ISBN: 978-0-07-786189-6
Publisher: McGraw-Hill
Required: Yes

Course Reserves:

N/A

Required Materials:

Students are required to have SPSS Grad Pack (Base) 24.0 1 Year. Available to students via remote access through CMU Virtual Lab for free. Students without reliable access to Internet should consider purchasing SPSS. This course will require

use of Respondus LockDown Browser and Respondus Monitor during examinations. The software will require the use of a webcam. If you do not have a web cam, one can be purchased through either MBS Bookstore or the CMU Bookstore. Use of Respondus software eliminates the need for traditional examination proctoring.

Recommended Materials:

N/A

III. COURSE DESCRIPTION

An introduction to the various research methodologies in Psychology. This course may be offered in an online or hybrid format.

IV. COURSE GOALS AND OBJECTIVES

The student will be introduced to the basic research methodologies of Psychology and the form of written research reports. After completing the course, students will be able to:

1. Apply the basic principles of scientific investigation and research ethics;
2. Collect and describe psychological data;
3. Use and report inferential statistics;
4. Find and comprehend primary research papers in Psychology;
5. Understand factorial research designs;
6. Interpret and discuss data collected with these designs;
7. Write using APA standards for written communication.

V. METHODOLOGY

1. Lectures covering selected topics will be presented in written form and in the form of narrated PowerPoint presentations. Students will use the discussion board to post questions for instructor feedback.
2. Participation: You are required to participate in weekly assignments involving all of the components of designing and conducting a research project. (See course outline.)

VI. COURSE OUTLINE/ASSIGNMENTS

Pre-Class Assignment:

- Log on to Blackboard, download the Syllabus and read it carefully.
- Access SPSS from the CMU Virtual Lab to ensure that you can open it, enter data, save the file and re-open it. Do this before class starts to avoid problems later.
- Complete and submit the Scavenger Assignment
- Complete the Discussion Board Assignment
- Complete and submit the PsycINFO Assignment

Course Outline:

Week 0 – Preparation

Complete and submit the Scavenger Hunt assignment

Complete the Discussion Board assignment

Complete and submit the PsycINFO assignment

Week 1- Introduction to Behavioral Research

Read and study Chapters 1, 2, and 3 in your textbook.

Read lecture notes on Chapters 1, 2, and 3.

Study the powerpoint lectures on Science and Research and Problem and Hypothesis.

Week 2- Basics of Behavioral Research

Read and study Chapters 4 and 5.

Read lecture notes on Chapters 4 and 5.

Review and study Chapters 1, 2, and 3

Review and study the Week 1 powerpoint lecture

Complete Exam 1

Week 3 –Observation and Survey Research

Read and study Chapters 6 and 7

Read lecture notes on Chapters 6 and 7.

Study the powerpoint lecture on Types of Research Methods

Week 4 – Statistical Inference and Experimental Design

Read and study Chapters 8 and 13.

Read lecture notes on Chapters 8 and 13.

Study the powerpoint lectures on Randomized Group Designs and Experimental Control

Complete and submit Research Project 1

Review Chapters 6 and 7

Review the Week 3 powerpoint lecture on Types of Research Methods

Complete Exam 2

Week 5 - Preparing and Conducting the Experiment, Small n, Quasi-Experimental, and Developmental Designs

Read and study Chapters 9 and 11

Read lecture notes on Chapters 9 and 11.

Study the Week 5 PowerPoint lecture on small n designs and quasi-experimental designs

Complete and submit Research Project 2

Week 6- Correlation and Generalization

Read and study Chapters 12 and 14

Read lecture notes on Chapters 12 and 14.

Study the powerpoint lecture on Correlation and Explanation, Prediction, and Generalization

Complete and submit Research Project 3

Review Chapters 9 and 11

Review the Week 5 powerpoint lectures on Small n Designs and Quasi-Experimental Designs

Complete Exam 3

Week 7- Factorial Designs

Read and study Chapter 10

Read lecture notes on Chapter 10.

Study the Week 7 powerpoint lecture on the Factorial Design

Complete and submit Research Project 4

Complete Exam 4

Week 8- Research Proposal

Read the research proposal notes.

Study the powerpoint lecture on the Research Proposal.

Complete the Research Proposal Checklist

Complete three research article summaries

Complete the Research Proposal paper.

Assignment Due Dates:

Each week's assignments are due before the end of Sunday of that week (11:59 pm, EST).

Post-Class Assignment:

None

Student Involvement Hours:

Students should have enough daily time (initially estimate more time than less) to accomplish the course objectives.

VII. CRITERIA FOR EVALUATION

Evaluation Criteria:

Points:

Week 0- A maximum of 70 points can be obtained

Scavenger Hunt – 30 points

Discussion Board – 20 points

PsyINFO – 20 points

Week 1- No assignments or exams are due for this week.

Week 2- A maximum of 150 points can be obtained

Exam 1- 150 points

Week 3 – No assignments or exams are due for this week

Week 4- A maximum of 220 points can be obtained

Research Project 1

Data collection -10 points

SPSS output – 10 points

Research Report – 50 points

Exam 2- 150 points

Week 5 – A maximum of 75 points can be obtained

Research Project 2

Data collection-15 points

SPSS output- 10 points

Research Report – 50 points

Week 6 – A maximum of 210 points can be obtained

Research Project 3

SPSS output-10 points

Research Report-50 points

Exam 3-150 points

Week 7- A maximum of 125 points can be obtained

Research Project 4

SPSS Output-15 points

Research Report-50 points

Exam 4-60 points

Week 8 – A maximum of 150 points can be obtained

Research Proposal

Research Articles Summaries-30 points

Checklist-20 points

Research Proposal paper-100 points

Total number of possible points for course = 1000

Grading Scale:

920-1000=A (92%)

900-919=A- (90%)

880-899=B+ (88%)

820-879=B (82%)

800-819=B- (80%)

780-799=C+ (78%)

720-779=C (72%)

700-719=C- (70%)

680-699=D+ (68%)

620-679=D (62%)

600-619=D- (60%)

<600=E (<60%)

Typical mathematical rounding rules will be followed. for example, a score of 87.5% will round up to an 88% (grade of B+) while a score of 87.4% will round down to 87% (a grade of B).

Late Assignments:

The total number of possible points you could earn for any unexcused late assignments (including exams) will be reduced by 50%. For example, if you submitted your Scavenger Hunt assignment late, you could only receive a maximum of 15 instead of 30 points

Make-ups and Rewrites:

By arrangement only.

VIII. EXPECTATIONS

Attendance and Participation:

Taking an online course in 8 weeks will be challenging. In order to be successful, you need to possess a good work ethic, be self-motivated, and self-disciplined. Of course, many of these characteristics are also important when you take a face-to-face class. The difference is that given the nature of a web course (it seems somewhat removed from your daily life), it is very easy to set it aside (i.e., it ends up at the bottom of your priority list), and before long you are way behind. Therefore, the key is to set aside enough daily time (initially estimate more time than less) to accomplish the course objectives. You need to carefully assess the time requirements and make sure you effectively use this time. If you think that you do not have sufficient time to devote to the course, then I would recommend that you drop the course and take it when you do have the time.

Academic Integrity:

Because academic integrity is a cornerstone of the University's commitment to the principles of free inquiry, students are responsible for learning and upholding professional standards of research, writing, assessment, and ethics in their areas of study. Written or other work which students submit must be the product of their own efforts and must be consistent with appropriate standards of professional ethics. Academic dishonesty, which includes cheating, plagiarism and other forms of dishonest or unethical behavior, is prohibited. A breakdown of behaviors that constitute academic dishonesty is presented in the CMU Bulletin (<https://bulletins.cmich.edu/>).

Student Rights and Responsibilities:

Each member of the Central Michigan University community assumes an obligation regarding self conduct to act in a manner consistent with a respect for the rights of others and with the University's function as an educational institution. As guides for individual and group actions within this community, the University affirms the general principles of conduct described in the Code of Student Rights, Responsibilities and Disciplinary Procedures at <https://www.cmich.edu/ess/studentaffairs/Pages/Code-of-Student-Rights.aspx>.

IX. SUPPORT SERVICES AND OTHER REQUIREMENTS

Library Research and Instruction Services

As a CMU student you have full access to the services and resources of the CMU Library. Reference librarians will help you find information on your research topic and answer other questions related to the library. The library's Documents on Demand office will obtain copies of the books and journal articles for you. Check out the library's website at <https://library.cmich.edu> for more information.

Reference librarian contact information:

1. By email: libref@cmich.edu
2. By online form: <http://libguides.cmich.edu/askalibrarianform>
3. By phone: (989) 774-3470.

Documents on Demand office contact information:

1. By email: docreq@cmich.edu
2. By online form: <https://illiad.cmich.edu/>
3. By phone: (989) 774-3022.

Writing Center

The CMU Writing Center is a free online service for all CMU students, providing help with grammar, citations, bibliographies, drafts, and editing of academic papers. Suggestions and feedback are typically provided within two business days. For additional information and to submit work, visit <https://www.cmich.edu/global/writingcenter/Pages/default.aspx>

Mathematics Assistance Center

The CMU Mathematics Assistance Center provides free tutoring in mathematics and statistics to students enrolled in select courses. Tutoring is available online and via telephone. To see what courses qualify and to register with the Math Assistance Center, visit <http://global.cmich.edu/mathcenter/tutoring-request.aspx>.

ADA

CMU provides individuals with disabilities reasonable accommodations to participate in educational programs, activities and services. Students with disabilities requiring accommodations to participate in class activities or meet course requirements should contact Student Disability Services at (800) 950-1144, extension 3018 or email sds@cmich.edu, at least 4 weeks prior to registering for class. Students may find additional ADA information and forms at <https://www.cmich.edu/ess/studentaffairs/SDS/Pages/default.aspx>

Note to faculty: CMU Administration will notify you if applicable; otherwise, the student will provide a "Notification Letter to the Instructor" outlining the accommodations the student is approved to receive.

X. BIBLIOGRAPHY

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Center Information

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Online Resources

CMU Computer Help Desk https://www.cmich.edu/office_provost/OIT/help/help_desk/Pages/default.aspx

Pre-Class Checklist <http://www.global.cmich.edu/cmuonline/checklist.aspx>

Online Learning Resource Center <http://www.global.cmich.edu/cmuonline/about/>

Drop/Withdrawal Policy: <http://global.cmich.edu/courses/drop-withdraw.aspx>